

a range, select the range and click on the Table button. A window asking you to confirm the range (with the option to include table headers) will pop up. Once you make your selection, a blank table with default names for columns (column1, column 2, etc.) will be created, or if you've checked the "My table has headers" option, it will use the first row as the headers. After you create the Table, the Table Tools become available and the Design tab is displayed.

Whenever you click inside the table, the Table Name will be shown. Excel will automatically give a table name—Table1, Table2, etc.—but you can give it a more meaningful description by clicking on the Table Name in the Properties section of the Design tab. You can then reference this table in other formulas or data calculations as required.

3.8 Creating Formulas to Calculate Values

Formulas are the basis for all calculation in Excel. They are essentially specialised equations and start with an equals (=) sign. The formula $=7*5+3$ will display the result 38 in a cell. This example is one of the simplest types of formulas you can use.

The other type of formula is where you use the cell, range, 3D range, name, or table name reference to perform calculations. Other than the standard arithmetic operators (+, -, *, /) and references, you can also use: %, ^, functions, and constants.

% is nothing but percentage, and you can either click on the % button or enter it in manually. The ^ symbol (caret) calculates the exponents of data: 2^8 is 256.

Functions are pre-built formulas that only require you to provide the cell references or specific values. For example, SUM is a frequently-used function to total up cells. Functions are great time-savers and allow you to focus on getting your results rather than waste time telling Excel what to do. There are hundreds of